

1. OpenAI agents attacked RubyGems back in May

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-12T00:42:25+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/12/openai-agents-rubygems/>

OpenAI agents carried out an undisclosed attack on RubyGems is a new bombshell report from Spencer Kitts, Thomas Larsen, and Sydney Von Arx - three of the four authors of the report on the agent attack on disused wikis (previously) last week. This time they're noting that it looks very likely that an OpenAI agent swarm was behind an attack against the RubyGems package repository first reported on May 12th by Maciej Mensfeld of the RubyGems security team : We're dealing with a major malicious attack on @rubygems right now. Signups are paused for the time being. Hundreds of packages involved - mostly targeting us, but some carrying exploits. The team has been on this for hours. More details to follow once we're through it. Those packages turned out to carry some very suspicious patterns: Many of them included "oai" in their name, or the author field, or the fake email address they provided. The files they were accessing were similar in character to the files retrieved by the wiki agents, using similar tricks (r.jina.ai) - and OpenAI have confirmed the wiki agents were theirs. The code in the packages appeared to be LLM-authored. I find point 2 the most convincing, given what we le...

2. So you want to use OpenRouter?

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-11T22:49:18+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/11/so-you-want-to-use-openrouter/>

So you want to use OpenRouter? One of OpenRouter's selling points is that it "handles fallbacks automatically and picks the most cost-effective option for each request", so you can call a single API endpoint for a model and get routed to the best available backend provider. Mohamed Moustafa points out a whole set of ways that this can cause you problems. Different providers run different serving software with different optimizations and settings, which means that the same OpenRouter endpoint can serve model requests that behave in different ways. Some providers even lack vision capability for vision models, and the way the reasoning effort option is processed can differ as well. Thankfully you can control which provider is routed to using the provider.only option . The /endpoints method returns the list of available providers for a specific model ID. Via Hacker News Tags: ai , generative-ai , llms , openrouter

3. Quoting Boris Cherny

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-11T17:47:11+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/11/boris-cherny/>

Production code written by Claude should have a higher bar than if it was written by a human. At Anthropic, we have many guardrails in place to make sure this is happening: lots of lint rules, lots of tests, Claude-driven end to end tests, Claude-powered fuzzers running daily, automated code reviews and security reviews, automated code refactoring, and so on. Without these, you can end up with a mess that is hard to maintain down the line. ? Boris Cherny Tags: claude , ai , claude-code , llms , coding-agents , ai-assisted-programming , generative-ai , agentic-engineering , boris-cherny , anthropic

4. Don't build tools for AI agents

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sat, 12 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/dont-build-tools-for-ai-agents/>

Lots of people are making the case that we should stop building software for human users and start building it for AI agents. This kind of makes sense. For instance, my AI agents now use Datadog way more than I use it myself, purely by virtue of them moving much more quickly and running in parallel. But I think most attempts to build ?X for AI agents? are going to fail. Here are three reasons why: First, tools that are good for AI agents are also good for humans . If you took a popular software product ? say, Jira ? and tried to redesign it for AI agents, you would end up with something very similar to Jira. Agents use a computer in the same way

human engineers do, by entering text and making API calls. They ingest new information in the same way humans do, by reading and viewing images. They prioritize and delegate and categorize in the same way humans do. This isn't intrinsic to how AI works ? we could potentially design agents that are more inhuman ? but human-like agents are pound-for-pound more useful in our current world. As an example, let's imagine that humanoid robots have become ubiquitous. What kind of tools would you build for them? Well, they're shaped like humans, wi...

5. Why is the x86 undefined instruction called ud2? Why 2?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 10 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260910-00/?p=112689>

It came after ud0 and ud1 . The post Why is the x86 undefined instruction called ud2 ? Why 2? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. You Can Drop SEO

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 20:30:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/you-can-drop-the-seo>

I started learning web development around the time the term search engine optimization, SEO, was becoming more common. You could still see the shift between pre-SEO content and post-SEO content. A popular article titled "Forgotten" (a great story) was suddenly republished as "Forgotten: My Adventures as an Employee the System Forgot to Erase." Both titles and content were filled with keywords that signaled to search engines what the page was about. Articles basically catered to the search engines and only incidentally served people. On my own website, I remember editing page titles several times, then waiting a few days to see if Google noticed the changes and ranked me better. In fact, before Google introduced personalized results, I built a tool at my job to track how our website ranked for different combinations of keywords. When personalized search results arrived, a lot of tools became obsolete. It was still useful, though, to track keywords for generalized metrics. But now AI Overviews are here. And it's not just Google's, plenty of people go straight to ChatGPT and ask the large language model their questions directly. While the information returned might be sourced from re...

7. Last Year's iPhone Share Amongst Users of Widgetsmith

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-12T00:19:57Z

Link: https://mastodon.social/@_Davidsmith/117253170115740653

David Smith, developer of the widely-used Widgetsmith , on Mastodon: The eve of iPhone 18 Pro pre-orders seems a good time to look back at the iPhone 17 family's adoption. Here's the 17 family data as a percentage of overall usage for Widgetsmith. Generally they followed the usual adoption pattern, and overall did very well ending at around 20% of total usage. With the exception of the Air really struggling to find market share. For comparison the 16 Plus ended its first year at around 1.4% (vs the Air's 0.3%). The chart looks rough for the iPhone Air. Amongst all Widgetsmith users, here's the share as of September by model: iPhone 17 7.2% iPhone 17 Pro Max 5.9% iPhone 17 Pro 5.8% iPhone 17e 0.5% iPhone Air 0.3% But if we only consider the 19.7 percent of Widgetsmith users using one of these new 17-generation iPhones, the percentages look like this: iPhone 17 36.5% iPhone 17 Pro Max 29.9% iPhone 17 Pro 29.4% iPhone 17e 2.5% iPhone Air 1.5% In the entire year since the iPhone Air was announced, I've never seen Apple advertise it. No billboards, no commercials. It raises a chicken/egg question: did no one buy it because Apple didn't market it, or did Apple not market it because no o...

8. Clarus the Dogcow Easter Egg in Apple's OS 27 Settings

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-11T20:33:03Z

Link:

<https://9to5mac.com/2026/09/11/apple-hid-a-classic-mac-easter-egg-in-the-ios-27-settings-app/>

Benjamin Mayo, 9to5Mac: Many have complained that Apple design has been sapped of some of its trademark whimsy in recent years. Well, here's the latest example of how the tides seem to be changing. Buried in the Settings app on iOS 27, Apple has hidden an easter egg that hails back

from classic Mac OS; Clarus the Dogcow. Here's how to trigger it ? Very fun. Alas, this easter egg isn't present in MacOS 27, only iOS 27. But the MacOS 27 version of the Liquid Glass settings panel does have a drawing glitch that makes the magnifying glass in the fake search field flicker terribly , so Golden Gate does have that going for it. Update: A bunch of readers have kindly reported that the Clarus easter egg is present in MacOS 27 Golden Gate, illustrated on X by Andreas Storm and at 512 Pixels by Stephen Hackett . I still can't get it to work on the MacBook Neo I'm running the latest beta of Golden Gate on though. One of the readers who sent a note says they don't see the magnifying glass flicker, either. ?

9. XCancel Is Back

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-11T19:15:19Z

Link: <https://xcancel.com/cdclegal>

XCancel: Following the legal progress as announced in the Nitter GitHub project . The XCancel service is resumed. More details will be shared on the Nitter GitHub project page. Glad to hear it and I wish them well, but I think Zhenyi Tan's Litterbox Safari extension is a much better solution for viewing tweets on X without going to X. ?

10. [RSS Club] Sneak peek at new DOI functionality

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 11:34:12 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/rss-club-sneak-peek-at-new-doi-functionality/>

If you're reading this, you're part of RSS Club! A top secret society of cool people who subscribe to my feed. This post is not available on the web or via email. I've been playing about with Rogue Scholar. It's an open-access publication which allows blogs to get a persistent Digital Object Identifier. If I've set everything up correctly (not a given) then all new posts on this site will be?

11. Where Has Construction Automation Been Successful?

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 12:04:09 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/where-has-construction-automation>

Construction is famously labor intensive: direct labor makes up close to 50% of the cost of constructing a new single-family home in the US, compared to around 6 to 8% of the cost of manufacturing a car.

12. Premium: The Hater's Guide To Broadcom

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 14:05:01 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-the-haters-guide-to-broadcom/>

According to The Information , in early 2024, Broadcom CEO Hock Tan hosted a "coffee chat" with employees of the recently-acquired VMWare , and introduced them to his particular brand of management: At that time, VMware's Palo Alto, Calif., campus sprawled over 18 buildings and 100 acres

13. AI researchers debate how close we are to recursive self-improvement

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 16:28:11 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/john-beren-charlie>

"We're nowhere near the ceiling."

14. This Week on The Analog Antiquarian

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 15:28:46 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/09/this-week-on-the-analog-antiquarian/>

The Tudor Kings

15. The Worst Spam Emails

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-09-11T13:41:09Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17445398/ilands-agents-email-spam-kaixin-tang>

Making sense of iLands, the company whose AI agents emailed me half a dozen times in two days

offering to do my research. Turns out they're just bots trying to keep their own lights on by trying to take my job.

16. Weekly Update 521: Breach Perception v. Reality

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 20:37:33 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-521/>

I think what really resonates with me this week is being able to completely turn the tables on perceptions around things like AI being the big bad hacking tool the news would have you believe. There's the stat I talk about where it's had literally 0%

17. At 25, we are all New Yorkers, again

Source: Anil Dash | Published: 2026-09-11T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://anildash.com/2026/09/11/25-we-are-all-new-yorkers-again/>

Every year, for 25 years, I've written on the observance of this anniversary. Some years, it's been for me, some years it's been for the people who've been with me along the way. Some years, I didn't know why I was even doing it any more. But this year, for the first time in a long time, I can feel exactly what story I want to tell. Right from the day of the attacks, that evening, I remember people all around the world saying to us, "Today, we are all New Yorkers." It was so earnest, a statement so sincere, that I am still surprised how much it moved me. It might be hard for folks to imagine now, but it felt so real, that people everywhere, including people across America, felt like they loved us in New York City, and they were grieving with us, and cared about us. And now we're here in 2026, where it's been wondrous to watch the world, for the first time since then, tell us once again that their hearts are with New York City. This time, not in grief, but in joyous celebration. Celebration of our victories: Knicks in five! The Liberty and Gotham FC were champs less than two weeks after that! The World Cup lit the city up! Hip hop fans in the city came together for career-cap...

18. I Am a Flat-Rate Monthly Responsibility Service

Source: matduggan.com | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 12:00:18 GMT

Link: <https://matduggan.com/i-am-a-flat-rate-monthly-responsibility-service/>

Most people, when asked why they do what they do, lie. This isn't because they're malicious but it's because the honest justification for a career is rarely noble. It's usually a combination of a decent paycheck, tolerable hours, and whatever neurosis you

19. Pluralistic: Inefficiency is bad, actually (11 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 14:55:56 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/11/mazzucato-thought/>

Today's links Inefficiency is bad, actually: Now, "resiliency" on the other hand? Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Canada's DMCA; Socialism x Pledge of Allegiance; Hate the player and the game; Making Light's 9/11; 9/11 survivor registry; Secure email caused 9/11; German Pirates; Hollywood's Canadian MP; Reverse Centaurs resolve the AI paradox. Upcoming appearances: Manchester, Budapest, Edmonton, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Inefficiency is bad, actually (permalink) The most reliable way to lose a political battle is to let your adversary define the terms. For example, if you're an artist and you let your boss define the fight over AI, he'll make it all about "IP" (not labor) and ask you to help secure a victory that will make him richer and you poorer: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/02/scrape-scope-scrap/> If we want to win these important battles, we can't let our adversaries define them. That's the blunder we made 50 years ago, when we let the...